The Throne and the Lamb

Revelation 1–7

The big idea: Revelation pulls back the curtain for suffering churches. The risen Jesus walks among his people and holds the keys of death. The throne of heaven is not empty. And the Lion of Judah conquers as the Lamb who was slain, ransoming people from every nation by his blood.

Before you meet: Read

Revelation 1:9–18 | Revelation 4:1–11 | Revelation 5:1–14

Open (5 minutes)

When the news is bad, what do you tell yourself about who is in charge?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"Fear not, I am the first and the last, and the living one. I died, and behold I am _____ forevermore." *(Revelation 1:17–18)*

"Worthy is the _____ who was slain, to receive power and wealth and wisdom and might and honor and glory and blessing!" *(Revelation 5:12)*

"Behold, I stand at the _____ and knock." *(Revelation 3:20)*

Discuss

1. What did you think Revelation was about before this week? What surprised you? *Revelation 1:1–3*

2. Why did John need to see the risen Jesus before he saw anything else? *Revelation 1:12–18*

3. The Lion conquers as the Lamb. What does that tell us about how God wins? *Revelation 5:5–10*

4. Jesus told the lukewarm church in Laodicea, "Behold, I stand at the door and knock." What would it look like to open the door to him this week? *Revelation 3:20*

Memory verse

> *"Worthy is the Lamb who was slain, to receive power and wealth and wisdom and might and honor and glory and blessing!"*
>
> **Revelation 5:12**

Pray

Worship the Lamb who was slain and now reigns. Bring him whatever is shaking your world, and thank him that the throne of heaven is not empty.

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Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Revelation 1:9–18 and 5:1–14 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Revelation 19:11–16, 20:11–15, and 21:1–22:5).

Main points to land

1. Revelation unveils Jesus Christ: the risen Lord who holds the keys of Death and Hades and walks among his churches (Revelation 1:1, 12–18; 2:1).
2. The Lion of Judah conquers as the Lamb who was slain, and by his blood he ransoms people from every nation (Revelation 5:5–10; 7:9–14).
3. Heaven's throne is not empty. Whatever happens on earth, God reigns over history, and heaven worships him day and night (Rev. 4:2, 8).

Answer key (Observe)

1. alive
2. Lamb
3. door

Questions people will ask

Why do Christians disagree so much about Revelation?
Revelation uses symbols drawn from the Old Testament, and faithful Christians read the timing of its visions differently. But they agree on the main message: Jesus reigns, he will return bodily, evil will be judged, and God will make all things new. Hold the details humbly and the main message firmly.

Closing prayer

Lord Jesus, you are the first and the last, the living one who died and is alive forevermore. You are worthy, Lamb of God. Keep us faithful under pressure, warm our hearts when our first love cools, and teach us to join heaven's song now. Amen.